

DECEMBER 18

Operation Linebacker II, known as the Christmas Bombing, begins. American B-52 bombers attack targets in Hanoi and Haiphong.



Christmas Bombing, December 1972

DECEMBER 20

Six B-52 bombers are shot down by North Vietnamese SAMs, forcing a revision of American bombing tactics.

DECEMBER 26

North Vietnamese cities are attacked by 120 B-52s. North Vietnam proposes a resumption of peace negotiations in January.

DECEMBER 29

Linebacker II is halted. The US Air Force has lost 16 B-52s shot down in the raids. The bombing has caused 1,624 civilian deaths.